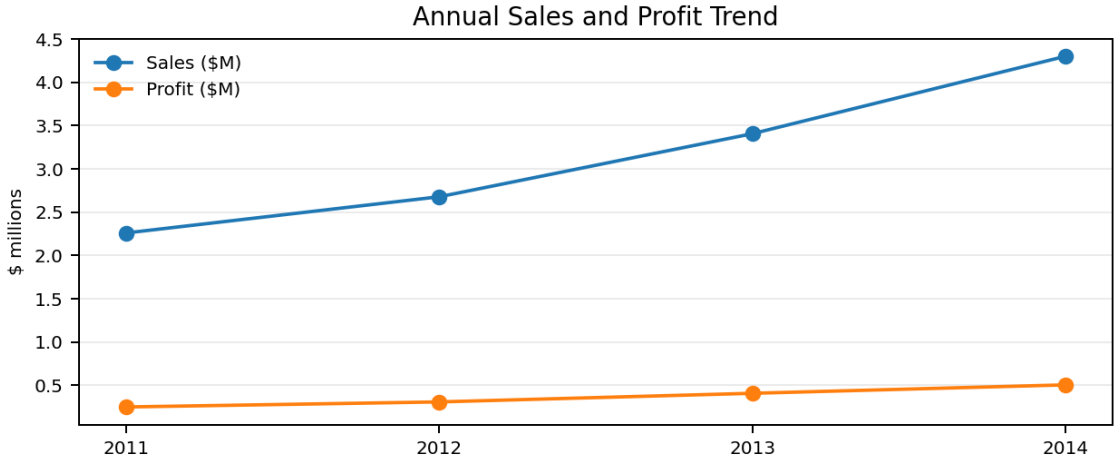
GLOBAL SUPERSTORE

Detailed Business Performance & Profitability Analysis

Executive-style analytical presentation based on the supplied workbook
Reporting period: 01 Jan 2011 – 31 Dec 2014 | 51,290 transaction lines | 25,035 orders | 1,590 unique customers

$12.64M	$1.47M	11.6%	14.3%	1,590	25,035
TOTAL SALES	TOTAL PROFIT	PROFIT MARGIN	AVG DISCOUNT	CUSTOMERS	ORDERS



Executive summary: the workbook contains $12.64M in sales and $1.47M in profit, equivalent to an 11.61% aggregate profit margin. This report examines how performance varies by year, category, sub-category, market, customer segment, discount band, and shipping mode. Findings are descriptive; recommendations are hypotheses to validate before operational changes.

1. Data Overview & Quality Checks

The workbook contains 51,290 rows and 24 columns. The analysis uses order dates, sales, profit, discount, quantity, customer, product, market, segment, category, sub-category, and shipping fields where available.

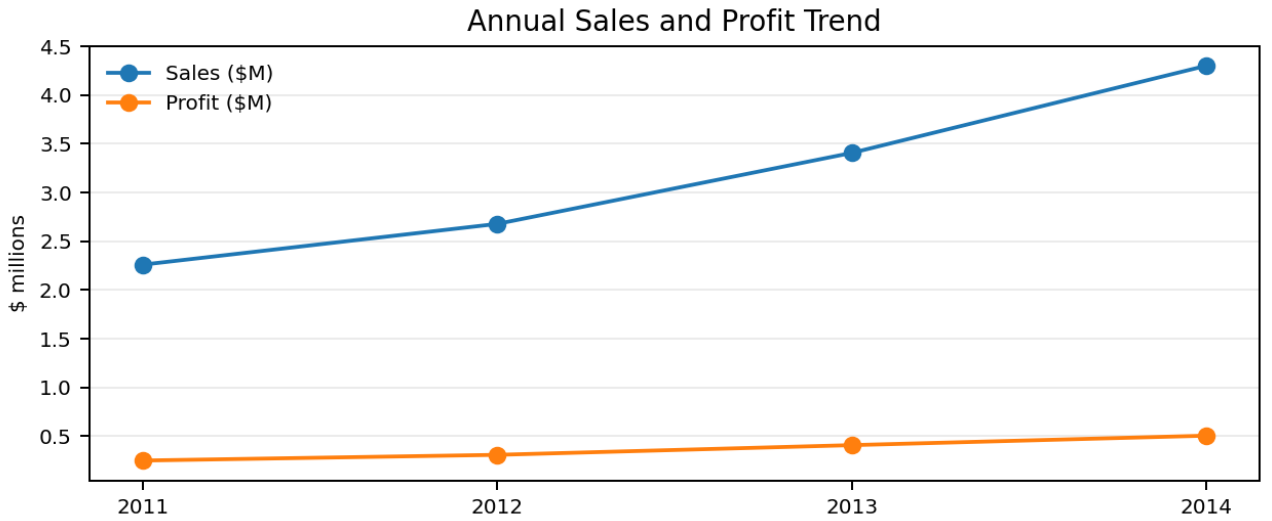
Exact duplicate rows detected: 0. Missingness is summarized below; nulls should be assessed by field rather than treated uniformly.

Field	Missing values	% of rows
Postal Code	41,296	80.51%
Row ID	0	0.00%
Order Date	0	0.00%
Order ID	0	0.00%
Ship Mode	0	0.00%
Customer ID	0	0.00%
Customer Name	0	0.00%
Ship Date	0	0.00%
Segment	0	0.00%
City	0	0.00%

Coverage: 01 Jan 2011 to 31 Dec 2014. Distinct products: 3,788. Total units sold: 178,312. Average order value: $504.99.

Quality checks should validate date parsing, currency consistency, duplicate handling, and the meaning of nulls before financial reporting. This report does not assume missing values should be imputed.

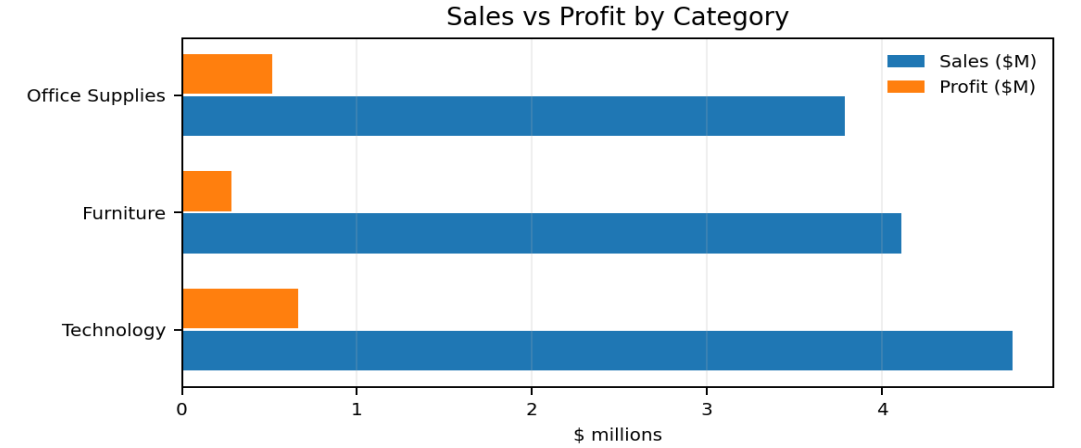
2. Sales & Profit Trend

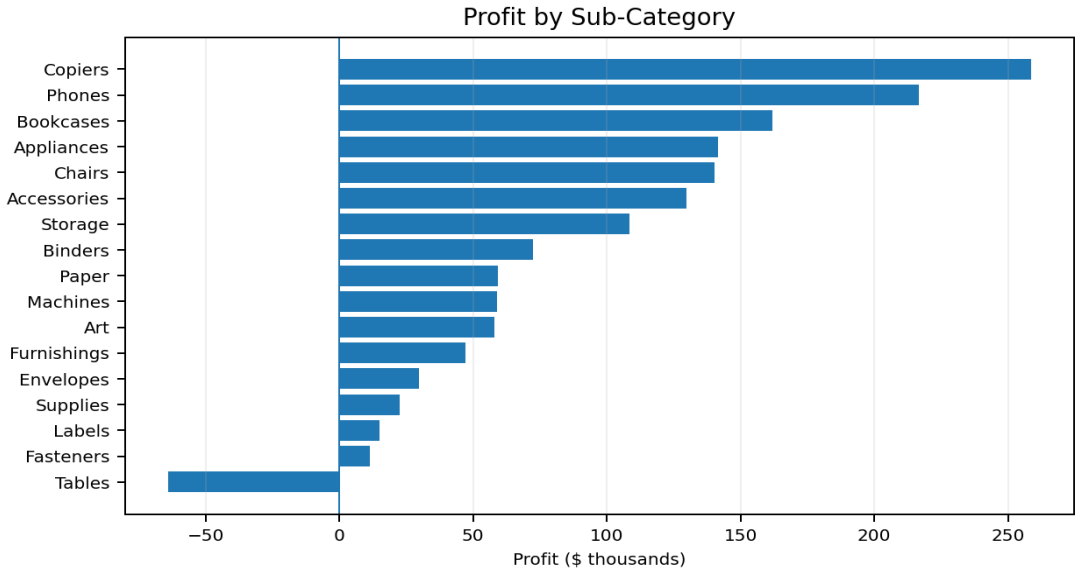


Year	Sales	Profit	Distinct orders
2011	$2.26M	$249K	4,440
2012	$2.68M	$307K	5,343
2013	$3.41M	$407K	6,721
2014	$4.30M	$504K	8,531

Annual trends help distinguish growth in transaction volume from improvement in profitability. Review profit growth alongside sales growth; a larger sales base does not automatically imply stronger unit economics.

3. Category & Sub-Category Performance

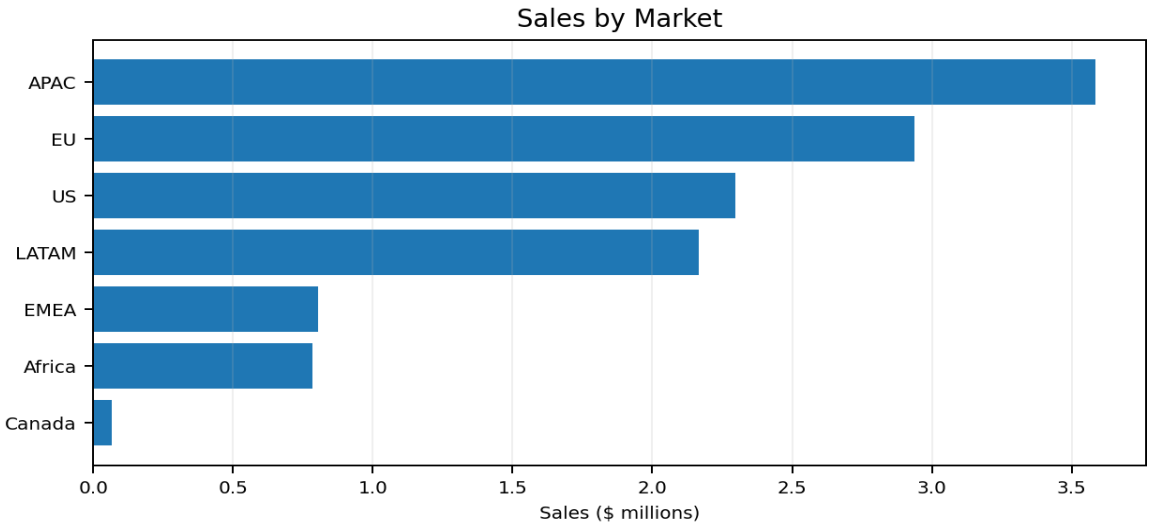




Category	Sales	Profit	Margin
Technology	$4.74M	$664K	14.0%
Furniture	$4.11M	$285K	6.9%
Office Supplies	$3.79M	$518K	13.7%

Highest-profit sub-category: Copiers ($259K). Lowest-profit sub-category: Tables ($-64K). Use sub-category results to prioritize product-level diagnostics, while assessing sales volume, discounting, returns, and shipping costs before changing assortment.

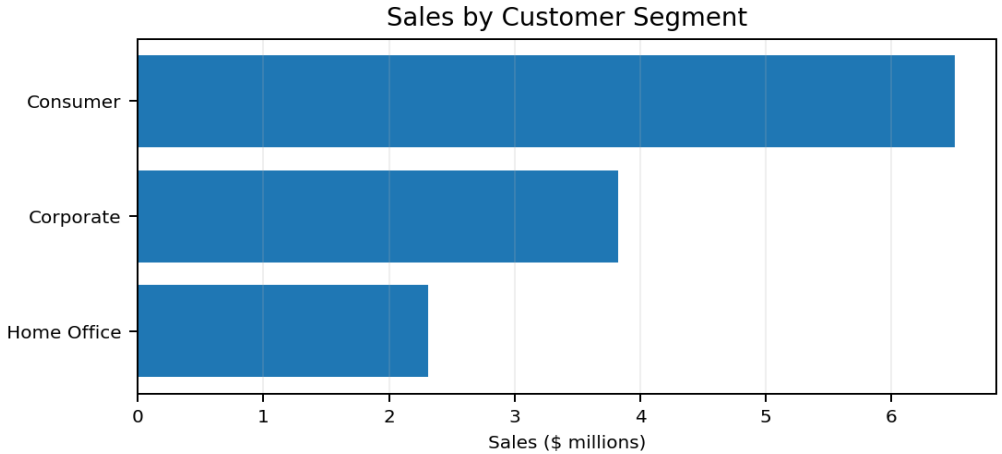
4. Market & Geography Performance



Market	Sales	Profit	Margin	Orders	Customers
APAC	$3.59M	$436K	12.2%	5,437	796
EU	$2.94M	$373K	12.7%	4,593	795
US	$2.30M	$286K	12.5%	5,009	793
LATAM	$2.16M	$222K	10.2%	5,138	794
EMEA	$0.81M	$44K	5.4%	2,462	760
Africa	$0.78M	$89K	11.3%	2,232	754
Canada	$0.07M	$18K	26.6%	201	181

APAC is the largest market by sales ($3.59M). The lowest aggregate margin among markets is EMEA (5.4%). Normalize comparisons for product mix, pricing, order volume, currency treatment, and fulfillment cost before allocating budgets.

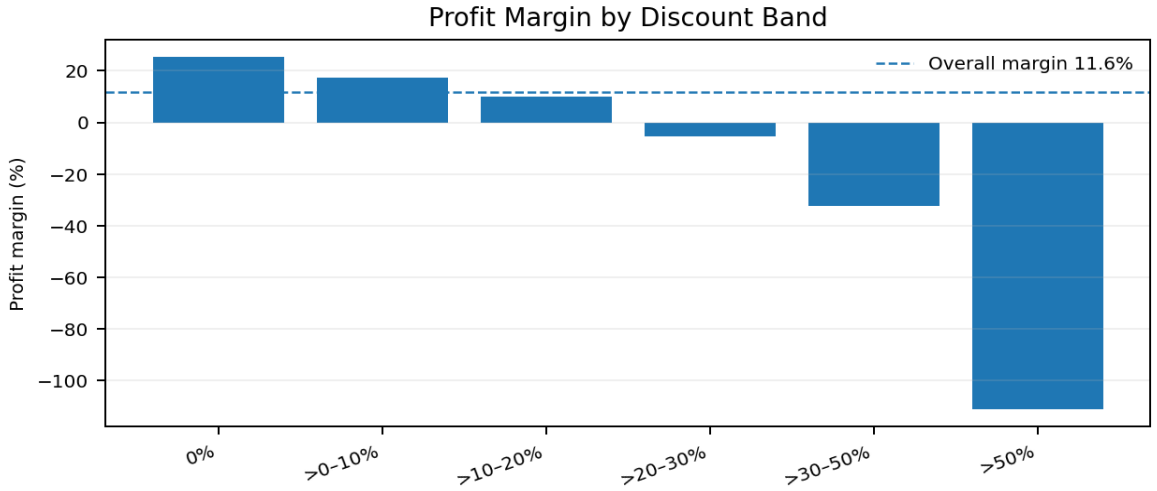
5. Customer Segment Analysis



Segment	Sales	Profit	Margin	Customers
Consumer	$6.51M	$749K	11.5%	818
Corporate	$3.82M	$441K	11.5%	476
Home Office	$2.31M	$277K	12.0%	296

Segment analysis separates sales contribution from profitability and customer reach. Compare margin and repeat purchase behavior, not only sales totals. This workbook summary does not establish customer lifetime value or retention without cohort and repeat-order analysis.

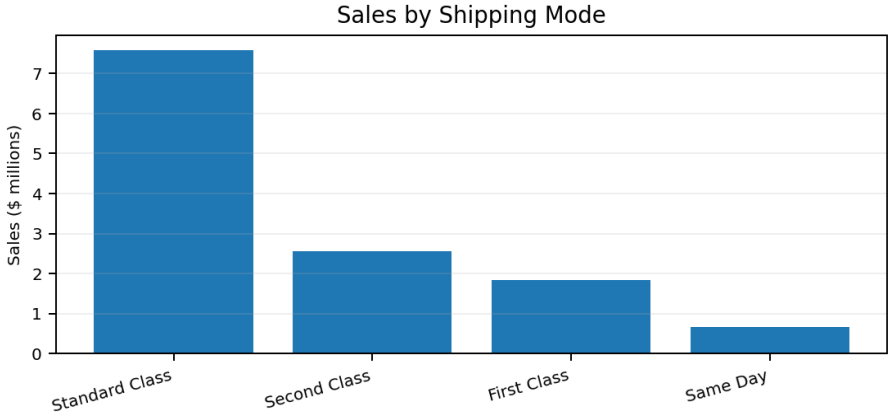
6. Discount Strategy & Margin Risk



Discount band	Records	Sales	Profit	Margin
0%	29,009	$6.99M	$1,771K	25.3%
>0–10%	4,679	$1.96M	$338K	17.2%
>10–20%	6,274	$1.76M	$173K	9.9%
>20–30%	967	$0.38M	$-21K	-5.5%
>30–50%	6,189	$1.18M	$-381K	-32.4%
>50%	4,172	$0.37M	$-413K	-111.0%

Average discount is 14.3% and median discount is 0.0%. Discount-band comparisons are descriptive: different products, markets, or customer types may receive different discounts. Do not infer that discounting alone caused the observed margin pattern without controlling for mix and other factors.

7. Shipping Mode & Fulfilment

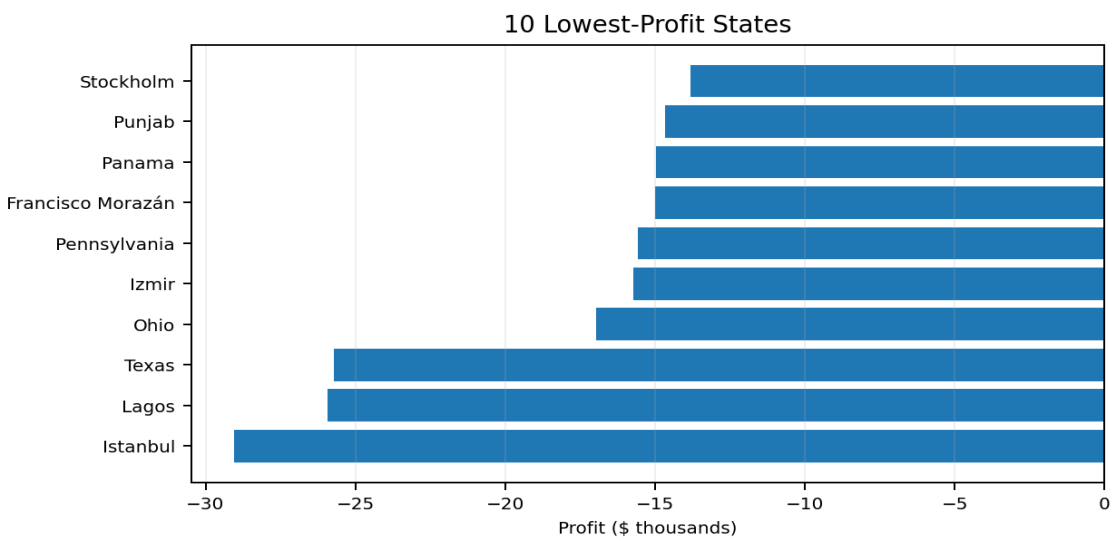


Ship mode	Sales	Profit	Margin	Orders
Standard Class	$7.58M	$891K	11.8%	15,154
Second Class	$2.57M	$293K	11.4%	5,119
First Class	$1.83M	$208K	11.4%	3,821
Same Day	$0.67M	$76K	11.4%	1,347

Average shipping cost per transaction line is $26.38. Compare shipping modes on margin and order mix, then validate service levels and delivery times. A mode with lower sales may still be strategically important if it supports customer experience or higher-value orders.

8. Loss-Making Transactions & State Review

24.5% of transaction lines have negative profit. These lines represent $2.49M in sales and a combined net loss of $-921K. This is a diagnostic flag, not a complete estimate of avoidable loss.



State	Sales	Profit
Istanbul	$0.03M	$-29K
Lagos	$0.02M	$-26K
Texas	$0.17M	$-26K
Ohio	$0.08M	$-17K
Izmir	$0.02M	$-16K
Pennsylvania	$0.12M	$-16K
Francisco Morazán	$0.05M	$-15K
Panama	$0.04M	$-15K
Punjab	$0.06M	$-15K
Stockholm	$0.02M	$-14K

Drill down into whether negative profit is concentrated in specific products, high-discount orders, expensive shipping, customer segments, or markets. State totals alone should not be treated as evidence of operational failure.

9. Recommended Action Plan

Priority	Action	Why it matters	Suggested KPI
1 — Immediate	Investigate loss-making lines by sub-category, discount, market, and ship mode.	Find controllable drivers instead of treating all losses equally.	Loss-line share; net loss
2 — Immediate	Set discount guardrails using margin and contribution profit.	Sales growth can conceal margin erosion.	Margin by discount band
3 — Near term	Review lowest-margin markets and sub-categories with price and assortment tests.	Prioritize targeted pricing.	Margin; profit per order
4 — Near term	Create a monthly performance scorecard.	Make trends and deviations visible.	Sales, profit, margin, orders
5 — Next phase	Analyze repeat customers and cohorts.	Measure retention and customer value.	Repeat purchase rate; cohort revenue
6 — Governance	Document currency, data definitions, and null-handling rules.	Improve reproducibility and trust.	Data-quality exceptions

Metric definitions

Total sales = sum of Sales; total profit = sum of Profit; aggregate profit margin = total Profit ÷ total Sales (11.6%); average discount = mean of Discount; customer count = distinct Customer ID; order count = distinct Order ID. Negative-profit line share = rows with Profit < 0 divided by total rows (24.5%).

Caveats: this is an exploratory analysis of the uploaded workbook, not audited financial reporting. Currency conventions, accounting definitions, returns, and cost allocation were not independently verified. Discount relationships are associative, not causal. Recommendations are proposed analysis priorities, not proven interventions.